VIT Bhopal University

School of Computing Science & Engineering

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Digital Literacy Portfolio – Project Report

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Submitted to:

VITyarthi E-Learning Platform – CSE0001 Course Faculty

Introduction

This project report documents my completion of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course project at VIT Bhopal University. As part of the assessment, I was assigned the role of a Student Digital Ambassador — a student representative responsible for helping peers navigate the digital world responsibly and professionally.

The project is structured around five tasks, each aligned to one module of the course. Together, these tasks cover the breadth of what digital literacy means for a first-year engineering student: creating visual content, building a professional online presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, communicating professionally via email, and developing awareness of cybercrime.

All work has been organized in a public GitHub repository, which itself forms part of the deliverable. This report documents the process, tools used, key observations, and personal reflections for each task. No prior coding experience was required to complete any task — all tools used are free and browser-based.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Module 1 | Marks: 20

Tool Used	Canva (canva.com)
Design Format	Single-page A4 infographic
Topics Covered	What Digital Literacy is; Safe Internet Practices; Professional Online Presence

Write-Up

For this task, I used Canva to create a one-page infographic titled 'Digital Literacy: Your Superpower in the Digital Age.' Canva was an ideal choice because it offers free, professionally designed templates that are accessible without any graphic design background. I selected a clean blue-and-white colour scheme to maintain a professional academic tone appropriate for a first-year student audience.

The infographic is divided into three visual sections. The first section defines digital literacy in plain language, using a laptop-and-lightbulb icon to represent the idea of knowledge empowered by technology. The second section presents safe internet practices in a checklist format, covering password hygiene, two-factor authentication, and avoiding phishing links. The third section shows a simple three-step roadmap for building a professional online presence: setting up a LinkedIn profile, creating a GitHub account, and maintaining professionalism on social media.

The most challenging part was deciding what to exclude — digital literacy is an enormous topic, and narrowing it down to three focused themes for a single page required several revisions. I found it fascinating how much visual hierarchy and whitespace affect readability. A cluttered infographic communicates nothing; a clean one communicates everything. This task taught me that good design is as much about restraint as it is about creativity.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Module 2 | Marks: 20

Platforms Set Up	GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle
GitHub README	Name, Branch, Year, Learning Goals
LinkedIn Section	Education: B.Tech CSE, VIT Bhopal, Exp. 2028

Write-Up

For this task, I set up professional profiles on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each serves a distinct and complementary purpose in a technology student's professional journey.

GitHub is a code-hosting platform built on Git version control. It is where developers store, share, and collaborate on software projects. I created a profile README repository displaying my name, branch, year, and a brief statement about my academic goals. LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform. It is used to connect with peers, professors, and recruiters, and to document educational and professional achievements. I filled in my Education section with my current degree, institution, and expected graduation year. Kaggle is a data science and machine learning competition platform. It provides datasets, notebooks, and courses that are widely used by students preparing for careers in analytics and AI.

Setting up these three accounts gave me a clearer sense of the digital landscape I am entering. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub as a living record of every project and assignment I complete, LinkedIn to begin professional networking from my second year onward, and Kaggle to explore data-driven problem-solving once I begin studying machine learning. The most surprising realisation was that my digital profile begins accumulating before I even write a single line of production code — and that its quality matters from day one.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Module 3 | Marks: 20

Coding Platform	HackerRank (hackerrank.com)
Challenge Completed	Python Introduction – Say Hello, World!
Collaboration Tool	Google Forms + Google Sheets
Form Created	Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz (5 questions)

Write-Up

This task had two parts. For Part A, I created an account on HackerRank and completed the Python Introduction challenge: 'Say Hello, World! With Python.' This challenge required writing a one-line Python program using the print() function — simple in execution, but meaningful as my first-ever act of programming. HackerRank awarded a badge upon completion. The platform is used by hundreds of companies globally for technical screening, so creating an account early is a wise career investment.

For Part B, I built a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The quiz includes two multiple-choice questions (on the definition of digital literacy and strong password practices), two short-answer questions (on phishing and professional platforms), and one true/false question about clicking unknown email links. The form is connected to a Google Sheet that automatically collects and displays responses in a spreadsheet.

Both platforms will be central to my academic life. HackerRank will help me track coding progress and prepare for placement assessments in third and fourth year. Google Workspace — particularly Forms, Docs, and Sheets — is already essential for course assignments, group projects, and committee work. Building the quiz for real use as a Digital Ambassador made this feel like a practical contribution rather than just a course exercise.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Module 4 | Marks: 20

Email Drafts

Email 1 – Assignment Extension Request

Subject: Request for Extension on [Assignment Name] – [Your Name] – [Reg. No.]

Dear Professor [Last Name],

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to respectfully request a short extension for the submission of [Assignment Name], originally due on [Date].

I have been working diligently on the assignment; however, I encountered an unexpected difficulty with [reason], which has slowed my progress. I want to ensure I submit work that accurately reflects my understanding.

If possible, I would greatly appreciate an extension of three additional days, until [Extended Date]. I am fully committed to delivering quality work within the revised timeline.

Thank you for your time and understanding.

Yours sincerely,
[Your Full Name] | [Reg. No.] | [Branch] | [College Email]

Email 2 – Summer Internship Interest

Subject: Application for Summer Internship – [Your Name] – B.Tech CSE, VIT Bhopal

Dear [Coordinator's Name],

I am writing to express my interest in a summer internship at [Company Name]. I am a first-year B.Tech student in Computer Science & Engineering at VIT Bhopal University, and I am eager to gain practical industry exposure during my upcoming summer break.

I am actively building my technical foundation in programming and digital tools, with a keen interest in [area of interest]. I believe an internship at [Company Name] would provide invaluable real-world experience that complements my coursework.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I might contribute to your team. Please find my GitHub and LinkedIn profiles at the links below.

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Yours sincerely,
[Your Full Name] | [Reg. No.] | B.Tech CSE Year 1 | VIT Bhopal
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Write-Up – Digital Communication Scenario

A realistic scenario that illustrates the consequences of poor digital communication is the case of a student who posted a frustrated comment about a professor on a public college Facebook group. Upset about a low grade, the student wrote an emotional post calling the grading 'unfair and biased,' tagging the professor's public page and the college's official handle. The post went viral within the student community and was screenshot by multiple people.

The consequences were immediate and lasting: the student was called in for a disciplinary meeting, the professor-student relationship was permanently damaged, and the post continued to circulate even after deletion. What could have been done differently? The student should have waited before acting, requested a private meeting with the professor to discuss the grade, and used a professional tone. A well-worded email — polite, specific, and solution-focused — would have resolved the concern without any public fallout. This scenario underscores the core principle of digital communication: once something is posted, you have lost control of it.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Module 5 | Marks: 20

Cybercrime Type	UPI / Online Payment Fraud
Case Study Format	Realistic fictional scenario based on documented fraud patterns
Source Referenced	NPCI guidelines; Cyberdost.gov.in
Prevention Tips	8 actionable tips including 2 UPI-specific
Reporting Channel	cybercrime.gov.in | Helpline: 1930

Case Study Summary

The case study describes a UPI fraud incident commonly known as the 'Wrong Transfer' trap, which frequently targets college students selling items on social media marketplaces. In the scenario, Ravi, a first-year engineering student, lists his old laptop for sale on a college Facebook group. A fraudster calls, expresses interest, and initiates what appears to be a UPI payment. The fraudster then claims to have sent an excess amount and pressures Ravi to return the difference. In reality, the fraudster had only sent a UPI payment request — not a credit — and Ravi ends up transferring ₹13,500 to the scammer with no recourse.

This type of fraud is deliberately designed to exploit UPI literacy gaps among first-time users. The key vulnerabilities targeted are: unfamiliarity with the difference between incoming credits and collect requests, social pressure created by urgency and sympathy, and the irreversibility of UPI transactions once completed.

Write-Up – Reflection

While researching this task, I was most surprised to learn how extensively UPI fraud exploits psychological manipulation rather than technical hacking. The fraudster in the typical scenario does not need any advanced technical skill — they only need to pressure the victim into acting quickly without thinking. The entire scam relies on the victim's instinct to be helpful and their unfamiliarity with how UPI actually works.

As a result of this research, I will personally change one habit: I will now always verify a UPI transaction in my bank statement before responding to any request related to a payment, rather than trusting app notifications alone. I will also share the Helpline 1930 number with my family, as online payment fraud affects all age groups, not just students.

Conclusion

This project has been a meaningful introduction to the practical dimensions of digital literacy. Across five tasks, I moved from understanding what digital literacy means conceptually to actively building the tools, platforms, and habits that define a digitally literate professional. I now have a GitHub repository, a LinkedIn profile, a HackerRank account, experience with Google Workspace, two professionally written email templates, and a significantly heightened awareness of online risks.

Perhaps the most important takeaway is that digital literacy is not a static skill set — it is an ongoing practice. Technology evolves rapidly, and staying digitally literate requires consistent curiosity, critical thinking, and a commitment to safe and ethical online behaviour. This course and project have given me a strong foundation from which to grow over the next four years of my engineering programme.

References

- Canva – Free Design Tool: https://www.canva.com
- GitHub – Code Hosting Platform: https://github.com
- LinkedIn – Professional Network: https://www.linkedin.com
- Kaggle – Data Science Platform: https://www.kaggle.com
- HackerRank – Coding Practice: https://www.hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – Quiz Builder: https://forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyberdost – Government Cyber Awareness: https://www.cyberdost.gov.in
- NPCI – National Payments Corporation of India (UPI Safety Guidelines): https://www.npci.org.in